



THIS IS A tabletop roleplaying game based on Johan Egerkrans' book *Vaesen: Spirits and Monsters of Scandinavian Folklore*. In this game, you and your friends will tell – or play – mystery stories together in the Mythic North – a fantasy version of 19th century Scandinavia, where myths and folklore are real. This Quickstart includes everything you need to begin playing except a handful of six-sided dice.

THE MYTHIC NORTH

The Mythic North is not historically accurate, but an alternate world where events may correspond more or less to our reality. As such, the stories do not take place in any specific period of the 1800s – the Mythic North combines phenomena from the entire century. Steamboats, trains, as well as political and philosophical movements from the end of the 19th century may well be mixed with earlier phenomena.

VAESEN

Throughout history, humans have shared their land with vaesen – trolls, ghosts, lindworms, and other creatures inhabiting the forests and the lakes. Many have helped the farmers in their back-breaking labor and made the dark, winter nights more bearable with enchanted music and gifts in the form of strange handicrafts to blacksmiths and lute players.

Although vaesen have always been present, few have actually seen them. The creatures are imperceptible to

the human eye – they choose whether to reveal themselves. It is said that their presence may be inferred from something as innocuous as a draft in the room, or from the abnormal behavior of farm animals.

Tales and songs tell of rules that must be followed so as not to anger the vaesen. Rural people often think they know how to avoid getting on the wrong side of those who dwell underground, but something has altered the balance between the humans on the surface and the creatures beneath. Vaesen have started attacking villages and destroying homes, factories, and train stations. They no longer behave as they do in the stories. Some think they have gone mad, others that the end times are nigh.

THE SIGHT

In this game, you take on the role of a person with the Sight, meaning that you have the ability to see vaesen – even when they are trying to remain invisible. You acquired the Sight as a result of some physical or psychological trauma, most likely some form of supernatural event, either during childhood or as an adult. Those who have the Sight are sometimes referred to as *Thursday's Children*.

WHAT IS A ROLEPLAYING GAME?

Roleplaying games are a form of collaborative storytelling, usually taking place around a table with papers and dice in front of you. All but one of you will have

a *player character* – a character to portray just like in a play or a movie. In this booklet we address both you, the player, and your player character as “you” – since you should be thinking of your character as “I.”

The person without a player character is the *Gamemaster*. Their role is to ensure that the story makes sense and keeps moving forward. The Gamemaster also describes what the world looks like and plays all the people who are not player characters. The individuals controlled by the Gamemaster are called *non-player characters* (NPCs).

The Gamemaster uses a mystery as a framework for the game. A mystery is a text much like a manuscript, except that the story you create around the gaming table does not have to unfold as written. It is more like a foundation for the Gamemaster to build on, suggesting things that could happen in the game and NPCs one might encounter. The mystery also includes clues and challenges – obstacles and dangers that might befall the player characters.

During the course of the game, situations will arise where your player character will attempt difficult or dangerous actions. On such occasions, the outcome is determined by rolling dice. How good your character is at doing things – such as shooting, sneaking, or interpreting clues – will affect your chance of success. You can read more about dice rolls on page 6.

It is important to remember that roleplaying is not a competition, but a collaboration. It is not the Gamemaster’s job to try to sabotage or kill the player characters – although they may of course place you in dangerous situations if that is where the story takes you. Sometimes it can be good to pause and talk about the game, to make sure that everyone is having fun.

SAFETY TOOLS

Vaesen is a horror game, and getting a good scare is part of the fun. That said, this is still a game, and no players should be forced to deal with topics they find distressing in real life, or that make them feel unsafe at the table.

To make sure everyone is having fun and feeling safe, we recommend that you use safety tools before, during, and after the game. Examples of such safety tools are pre-game discussions about lines and veils for subjects that players want to avoid or keep off-screen, safety cards to be shown during play by a player to indicate that they feel uncomfortable with what is happening in the game, and post-game debriefings.

Always respect any player’s wish to raise a concern at any time during the game, or even leave the table if they want to. And don’t forget to take breaks. More information about safety tools in tabletop roleplaying can be found online.

THE FULL GAME

This Quickstart includes five pre-generated characters and the mystery *The Archivist’s Curse*, giving you a taste of the game and the Mythic North. Once you have played it, you are ready to take on the full *Vaesen* game.

The *Vaesen* core rulebook, available separately, includes rules for creating your own characters, a wide range of mysterious *vaesen* to face, a trove of information about the Mythic North, and a host of other resources.

Beyond the core rulebook, a starter set and several expansions are available – some including thrilling new mysteries to play, other also expanding the game into other areas of the world.



PLAYER CHARACTERS

At the back of this Quickstart, you will find five pre-generated characters to choose from. This section explains the terms you will find on their character sheets. Play your character wholeheartedly and place them in dangerous and interesting situations. Do not hold back – it is more fun that way.

GENDER ROLES

The real 19th century was a patriarchal society where women were constrained in what they could do, say, and what jobs they could hold. However, this roleplaying game is not about the real 19th century but the Mythic North, and historical injustices don't need to limit the choices for female player characters.



Samuel Mäkinen
— private detective



Dorotea Borelius
— doctor

MOTIVATION

Your *motivation* explains why you are willing to risk your own life to track down vaesen. It helps you play your character.

TRAUMA

Your *trauma* is the event that gave you the Sight. It could be an incident from your childhood or something more recent, but usually it has some connection to the supernatural.

DARK SECRET

Your *dark secret* is a problem you are ashamed of and therefore keep to yourself. Incorporating the secret into the game makes the mysteries more fun – even if it may cause trouble for your player character.

ATTRIBUTES

Four core attributes determine your basic abilities: Physique, Precision, Logic, and Empathy. Each attribute has a rating between 2 and 5 and affects your ability to succeed at skill rolls connected to the attribute in question (page 6).

SKILLS

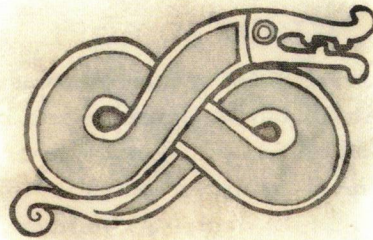
Skills represent acquired knowledge, training, and experience. There are twelve skills, all of them listed on the character sheet. Each skill is linked to one of the four attributes, and has a level between zero and 5. The skill level, together with its linked attribute, determines your chances of success when attempting something difficult or dangerous.

TALENTS

Talents are tricks, moves, and minor abilities that give you a small benefit. They are more specialized than skills and make your character unique. The effects of your talents are pre-printed on the character sheets in this boxed set. The *Vaesen* core rulebook includes a wide variety of talents.

RELATIONSHIPS

At the start of the mystery included in this Quickstart, *The Archivist's Curse*, your characters don't know each other, but you can determine how you feel about each other during the course of the game. Relationships should be interesting, without turning you into enemies – you must be able to work together.



GEAR & MEMENTO

Your character sheet lists the personal gear that you start the game with. You get to keep this gear even after the mystery is over.

Memento: In addition to your regular gear, you get a memento that will help you play and portray your character. Once per session, you can also use your memento to heal two Conditions while resting (page 16).

Temporary Gear: During the mystery, your character may find more useful items. As opposed to personal gear, such temporary gear can generally not be kept after the mystery is over – it's assumed to be sold, lost, or returned to its owner. You can read more about this in the *Vaesen* core rulebook.

RESOURCES

Your Resources rating indicates how rich you are, and your standard of living. The Resources rating is not used in this Quickstart – see the full *Vaesen* core rulebook for more information about it.

MAKING SKILL TESTS

Most of what happens in a game of *Vaesen* is handled through conversations between the players and the Gamemaster. But sooner or later, a player character will attempt something difficult or dangerous, where success is not guaranteed. In that case, it is time to bring out the dice and let chance decide what happens next. This is called a skill test.

WHEN TO ROLL

These rules or *The Archivist's Curse* mystery indicate when to roll for a skill, but the Gamemaster is also free to call for a skill roll in a situation they feel warrants it. We recommend against excessive dice rolling however, saving the rolls for dramatic and tense situations where something is truly at stake.

SIXES MEAN SUCCESS

To make a skill test, add your skill level to your score in the attribute linked to the skill, and grab that many six-sided dice. Then roll all the dice together. For your skill test to succeed, you must roll at least one six (6) – if not, the test fails.

No Skill Level? If you don't have the skill required for the particular action you want to perform, you can roll anyway – simply roll a number of dice equal to your attribute.

***Player 1 (Kaspar Ståhl):** I put on the cowl and the mask, and sneak into the church.*

***The Gamemaster:** It's dark and cold, and the great double doors of the church are decorated with demonic faces made of metal. As you open them, you hear the murmur of a hundred or so people – all wearing cowls. There must be several villages gathered here. There are red candles burning all over the place. Someone is playing a stringed instrument you can't identify. At the front stands a person facing the crowd. Their face is shrouded by a hood. Make a **STEALTH** test.*

THE SKILLS

- ✦ **AGILITY** (Physique)
- ✦ **CLOSE COMBAT** (Physique)
- ✦ **FORCE** (Physique)
- ✦ **MEDICINE** (Precision)
- ✦ **RANGED COMBAT** (Precision)
- ✦ **STEALTH** (Precision)
- ✦ **INVESTIGATION** (Logic)
- ✦ **LEARNING** (Logic)
- ✦ **VIGILANCE** (Logic)
- ✦ **INSPIRATION** (Empathy)
- ✦ **MANIPULATION** (Empathy)
- ✦ **OBSERVATION** (Empathy)

***Player 1:** I have Precision 2 and **STEALTH** 2. That's four dice. No sixes – I fail!*

***The Gamemaster:** The person at the front pulls back his hood. It's your brother. Your eyes meet.*

MODIFIERS

The rules or the Gamemaster can modify your chances, adding or removing dice for you to roll. This is referred to as +1 die, +2 dice etc., and conversely -1 die, -2 dice etc. You can never go below one die.

Gear: Weapons and other equipment can modify your roll, but not always. Sometimes a specific item is needed just to perform the action.

HELPING

Up to three other player characters or NPCs can help you with a dice roll. Each person helping you gives you +1 die, but they need to be in a position to actually support your action in a concrete way. The Gamemaster has final say. In combat, helping someone uses up your full action for the round.

MULTIPLE SUCCESSES

The more successes (sixes) you roll, the better the result. In combat (page 10), that usually means more damage, but it can mean any number of bonus effects. The mystery text or the Gamemaster has final say on what extra successes can be used for.

FAILED TESTS

Failing a skill test means that something detrimental or unexpected happens to you. In most situations the implications are obvious. Sometimes you may suffer a Condition, or worse (page 14). Even before the roll is made, the Gamemaster should try to be clear about what happens if the test fails.

ROLLING A D6

The rules sometimes ask you to roll a D6. This simply means rolling a die and reading the number, instead of counting successes (sixes).

***Player 2 (Astrid Lilja):** I sit down across from the sorcerer, staring into his eyes. "Do your worst!" I let him use his powers on me. But I'm trying to resist and understand how he is controlling others.*

***The Gamemaster:** Make an **OBSERVATION** test. If you fail, he takes control of you. You will also suffer a mental Condition.*



PUSHING THE ROLL

Having failed a skill test, or if you just need more successes (sixes), you can choose to muster your strength and give it one more try. This can only be done once per test, and must happen immediately after failing the test.

This is called pushing the roll, and means that you re-roll all of the dice (except the sixes, should there be any) and use the new result instead.

Having pushed a roll, you suffer a Condition. If you are rolling for a skill using Physique or Precision, you must choose a physical Condition, and if you are using Logic or Empathy, you choose a mental Condition. Read more about Conditions on page 14.

Player 1 (Kaspar Ståhl): I shout at him: "I'm your brother!" I try to get him to snap out of whatever spell he is under.

The Gamemaster: Make a **MANIPULATION** test.

Player 1: I roll three dice, but fail. I choose the Condition Angry and push the roll. I grab him, screaming: "Look into my eyes, Roland!" Then I re-roll all three dice.



Player 1 (Kaspar Ståhl): No way. I run straight into you and yank the axe from your hands.

The Gamemaster: You'll need to make an opposed roll. Kaspar, you roll for **AGILITY** while Ilyenka rolls for **CLOSE COMBAT**.

Player 1: I got two successes.

Player 3: Me too.

The Gamemaster: Then it's a compromise. How about this: Kaspar manages to push you away, positioning himself in front of his brother, but fails to take the axe and suffers a physical Condition?

OPPOSED TESTS

When facing an active resistance to a skill test, you and your opponent each make a roll. The person with the most successes (sixes) wins the test. Should both get an equal number of successes, you get what you want, but something goes wrong.

In a conflict between two player characters, where both roll the same number of successes, each may choose to push the roll to win. If you still get the same number of successes, you must agree on a compromise. Both get something they want, but at a cost.

The Gamemaster: As you throw the holy water on Kaspar's brother it creates a shockwave that knocks both you and him off your feet. Kaspar, when you get up you see your brother on his knees. His eye color has returned to normal.

Player 3 (Ilyenka Prokotin): I snatch one of the axes and sever his head from his neck.

PASSIVE ROLLS

Sometimes, the Gamemaster will ask you to roll for something you're not even aware of – typically **VIGILANCE** to spot an approaching threat. Passive rolls cannot be pushed. The Gamemaster can even make some passive rolls in secret.

NPCs & SKILLS

Non-player characters use skills in the same way as player characters, with the one major difference being that NPCs rarely push rolls (but can do so if the Gamemaster so decides). The Gamemaster rolls dice for NPCs, but should only roll for actions that affect a player character directly.



COMBAT

Combat begins when you or someone else attempts to shoot, hit, or otherwise harm someone. Combat is divided into rounds, approximately 5–10 seconds long. During each round everyone takes turns performing actions. When everyone is done, the round is over and another one begins.

INITIATIVE

To determine the initiative, ten cards numbered 1 to 10 are used. Such initiative cards can be found in the Starter Set for the game, but you can also use normal playing cards. Each player in the fight draws a random card at the beginning of each round, and the Gamemaster draws cards for NPCs and vaesen. If you are facing multiple similar opponents, the Gamemaster may choose to draw a single card for them as a group.

The number on the card determines the order in which you act in the round. Card #1 acts first, card #2 acts second, and so forth until everyone has acted. Your place in the initiative order is called your turn. Your “previous turn” or “your next turn” can occur in the current round or the previous/next round, depending on if you’ve had your turn in the current round yet.

Place your initiative card by your character sheet so everyone can see the order in which each person

acts. The Gamemaster places their card (or cards) in front of them. When all participants have had their turn, the round is over, and a new round begins.

SWAPPING INITIATIVE

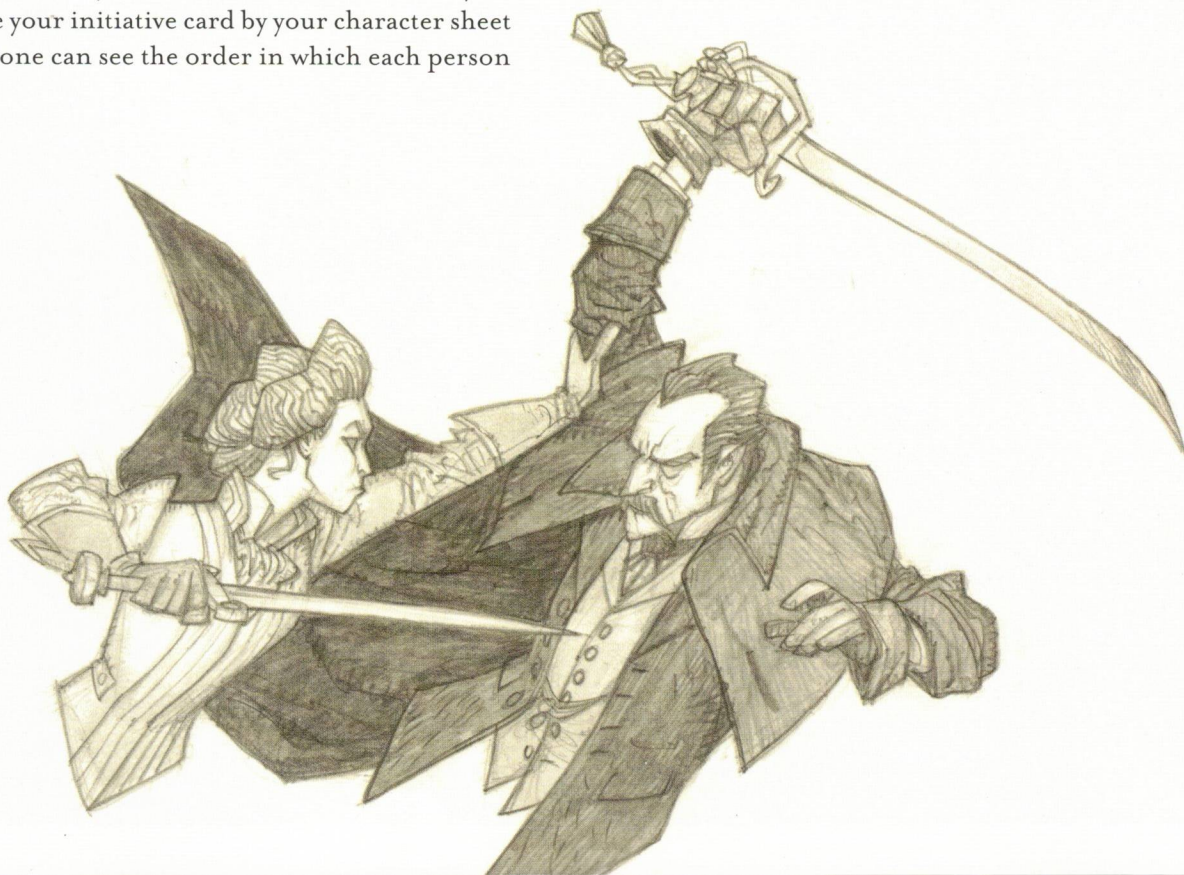
At your turn in the round, you can choose to you swap initiative cards – and therefore places in the turn order – with another player character or NPC (or NPC group) whose turn comes after yours. They cannot refuse the trade and must take their turn immediately. You cannot swap initiative cards with someone who has already had their turn.

All rules effects that are triggered “on your turn” are moved in the turn order when initiative cards are swapped. Your turn doesn’t happen until you use it.

Reactions that occur out of turn (such as dodging and parrying, see page 12) are not affected by swapping cards – spent fast actions still count as spent, even if you get a new initiative number.

VAESEN

Some vaesen are so fast that they get several turns per round. For these, the Gamemaster draws one initiative card for each turn.



ZONES & RANGE

The scene where combat takes place is divided into zones. A zone is an area where it only takes a couple of steps to engage the enemy in close combat. To hit enemies in another zone, you need some type of ranged weapon. Zones can vary in size depending on terrain. Usually, it is an open space delimited by walls, stairs, a river or other similar features. Indoors, one zone is typically a room or a corridor.

FIGHTING VAESEN

Everything you have heard about vaesen suggests that they can rarely be killed in combat. Physical confrontations with them will almost always be a matter of holding them off long enough to perform a ritual or escape. Performing a ritual rarely requires any skill tests. Instead, you describe what you are doing. If performed correctly, the ritual will drive the vaesen off.

The Gamemaster: *The myling seems bigger than before.*

Its bird-like body hovers over the mill without moving its wings. Suddenly it dives, banging its talons against the building. The mill leans further and further over the stream. Here and there boards come off or snap in two.

Player 3 (Ilyenka Prokotin): *I open the hatch on the floor.*

The Gamemaster: *Down there you see the corpse of a child, wrapped in rotting cloth. It can't have been dead for more than a couple of days.*

Player 2 (Astrid Lilja): *I gently pick up the child. "We have to bury the body. Someone must give their name to the child, or the myling will never be at peace."*

The Gamemaster: *The myling's talons are tearing away at the walls around you.*

Player 1 (Kaspar Ståhl): *"It can have my name!" Is there any place we can bury it?*

The Gamemaster: *There's dirt in the hole where you found the body. You could bury it there.*

Player 2: *I take out my bible and my crucifix to consecrate the ground.*

SLOW & FAST ACTIONS

Humans, animals, and most vaesen can perform two actions per round, one slow and one fast. Slow actions take more time and usually involve a skill test. Fast actions are quick and rarely require a test to succeed. If you want, you can perform a fast action instead of your slow one and thus get two fast actions that round.

REACTIONS

Some fast actions are reactions – usually some kind of maneuver to evade attacks. Reactions may be performed at any time during the round. This means that you can use your fast action before your turn, or wait until after your turn to be ready for an enemy's attacks. When using reactions to protect yourself, you must choose to spend your action before you know whether your opponent's attack roll fails or succeeds.

DESCRIBING ACTIONS

When performing an action, you must also describe it. This is part of creating the game's atmosphere and bringing the story to life. Perhaps you plunge yourself into the mud, swearing as you fire your rifle at the creature. Or maybe you crouch down, sneaking toward the enemy, gripping your knife so tight your knuckles turn white.

MOVEMENT

You can use a fast action to position yourself anywhere within your zone. If the enemy is hiding behind cover or located far away in the zone, you may have to spend a fast action to get close enough to make a close combat attack. Entering an adjacent zone also requires a fast action.



ATTACKING

Attacking an enemy requires a skill test. Unarmed attacks are performed with **FORCE**. When armed with a melee weapon, you use **CLOSE COMBAT**. For ranged attacks, you use **RANGED COMBAT**.

You need one success to hit your target, dealing damage as indicated by the weapon. The damage rating shown is the number of physical Conditions the enemy suffers as a result of your attack. For each extra success (six) you rolled, the opponent suffers another Condition.

WEAPONS

The list of weapons below indicates the base damage rating, the minimum and maximum range of each weapon, and the amount of bonus dice you may roll when using the weapon.

RANGE

The range is measured in zones. A zero means that you can only use the weapon against an enemy in the same zone. A weapon cannot be used beyond its maximum range. It is possible to use a weapon below its minimum range, but with -2 dice.

DODGING & PARRYING

When attacked, you can use your fast action to parry in close combat, or dodge a ranged attack. You can do this even if it is not your turn. This means that you can choose to save your fast action in case you need to parry later in the round, but you can also use it before your turn.

You dodge or parry by passing a skill test. You use **AGILITY** to dodge, and **FORCE** or **CLOSE COMBAT** to parry depending on whether or not you are armed. Each success eliminates one success from the enemy's attack. If you eliminate all the enemy's successes, the attack misses.

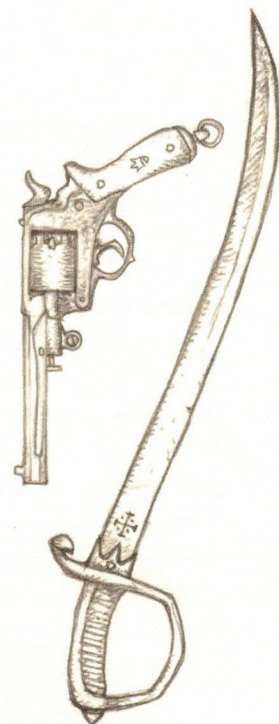
You must declare a dodge or parry before you know whether the enemy has succeeded with their attack.

GRAPPLING

When attempting to grapple your opponent, you make a **FORCE** test. The attack can be parried normally. If you succeed, your opponent is restrained and cannot perform any actions other than trying to break free or shouting. Preventing your opponent from speaking requires an extra success.

WEAPONS

WEAPON	DAMAGE	RANGE	BONUS	SKILL
Kick or punch	1	0	±0	FORCE
Club	1	0	+1	CLOSE COMBAT
Knife	2	0	±0	CLOSE COMBAT
Saber	2	0	+2	CLOSE COMBAT
Axe	2	0	+1	CLOSE COMBAT
Bow	1	0-2	+1	RANGED COMBAT
Pistol or revolver	2	0-1	+2	RANGED COMBAT
Musket	2	1-2	+1	RANGED COMBAT
Rifle	2	1-3	+2	RANGED COMBAT



The opponent is restrained until you let them go or they break free. Once per round, they may use a fast action to break free using a **FORCE** roll. You can resist the attempt by spending a fast action (also rolling for **FORCE**), turning it into an opposed roll.

FLEEING COMBAT

You can use the **AGILITY** skill to flee from combat. A successful skill test means that you leave the fight. If you fail, you remain in the same zone. You cannot flee if doing so would require you to move through a zone occupied by an enemy.

An opponent standing in the same zone as you can try to prevent you from fleeing, spending a fast action and making an **AGILITY** test. Each success eliminates one success from your result. If your opponent eliminates all of your successes, you are forced to stay in the fight.

AMBUSHING

In order to ambush your opponent, roll for **STEALTH** against their **VIGILANCE**. If successful, you can choose any initiative card you want at the start of combat. Each extra success adds +1 to your first action of the round. If the ambush fails, you are detected, and initiative is drawn normally.

If there are several ambushers, only one of you makes a **STEALTH** test. The result applies to all of you, and you may choose the initiative cards you want and distribute them among you as you see fit.

In some situations, the Gamemaster may decide that no skill test is required in order to surprise your enemy. You then automatically win the initiative.



DAMAGE & CONDITIONS

By pushing skill tests or taking damage you may suffer *Conditions*. You can suffer three *physical* or three *mental* Conditions before being Broken – see the adjacent list. The attribute linked to the skill you pushed, or the type of damage (mental or physical) you suffered, determines the type of Condition that afflicts you.

TAKING A CONDITION

When you suffer a Condition, you can choose any Condition you like from the relevant type (physical or mental), it makes no mechanical difference. Choose a Condition that fits the scene.

BROKEN

When you have checked off all three physical or mental Conditions and suffer another one of the same type, you are *Broken*. This means that you are incapacitated or have suffered a breakdown, and are unable to act. If Broken by physical Conditions, you risk dying.

BROKEN BY PHYSICAL CONDITIONS

If you are Broken by physical Conditions, you must make a **FORCE** roll each round (slow action). These rolls cannot be pushed. Note down all successes rolled. As soon as three successes have been rolled in total, you are no longer Broken, and you heal an additional physical Condition for each additional success rolled beyond the three.

If three **FORCE** rolls fail before three successes are achieved, your character dies. Before this happens, someone else can save you with a **MEDICINE** roll (slow action), with each success beyond the first healing an additional physical Condition. Suffering additional damage while Broken counts as a failed **FORCE** roll.

BROKEN BY MENTAL CONDITIONS

If you are Broken by mental Conditions, you may make an **OBSERVATION** roll in every subsequent scene. These rolls cannot be pushed. As soon as a roll succeeds, you are no longer Broken, and you heal an

CONDITIONS

Physical Conditions

- ◆ Exhausted
- ◆ Battered
- ◆ Wounded

Mental Conditions

- ◆ Angry
- ◆ Frightened
- ◆ Hopeless

additional mental Condition for each additional success rolled beyond the first. Someone else can heal you with an **INSPIRATION** roll (slow action), with the same effects as the **OBSERVATION** roll.

CONDITIONS FOR NPCs

Human NPCs and animals suffer Conditions just like player characters. However, for NPCs the Gamemaster doesn't need to keep track of specific Conditions – only the number of Conditions suffered matters.

TOUGHNESS

Furthermore, an NPC is Broken when they have suffered a number of Conditions in excess of their Toughness rating. Each NPC has a physical and mental Toughness. When an NPC is Broken by physical Conditions, the Gamemaster can simply decide that they are unconscious or killed outright.

CONDITIONS FOR VAESSEN

Vaesen can suffer Conditions from attacks, but each vaesen has a unique list of Conditions with specific effects. This is described in the full *Vaesen* core rulebook.

PERMANENT EFFECTS

The full *Vaesen* core rulebook includes more rules for critical injuries and potentially permanent effects from them, called *Afflictions* and *Insights*.

CHARACTER DEATH

The death of a player character can be traumatic but try not to see it as a failure. Instead, consider it a dramatic peak in your story. If there are any NPCs nearby, the player can take over them for the remainder of the mystery. The full *Vaesen* core rulebook includes rules for creating new characters.



FEAR

When encountering vaesen or other terrifying events, you must pass a Fear test to avoid being *Terrified*. This is not an action. Choose whether to roll for Logic or Empathy. You cannot use any skill, but you get +1 die for each other player character present in the scene, up to a maximum of +3 dice (Broken or Terrified characters don't count).

The Fear value of the creature, magic, or occurrence indicates how many successes (sixes) you need to roll to avoid being Terrified. If successful, you manage to control your emotions and can act normally.

If you fail to roll enough successes, you suffer a number of mental Conditions equal to the Fear value minus the number of successes you did roll. In addition, you become Terrified, and must choose to flee, freeze, faint, or attack in a frenzy (see the adjacent list).

The Gamemaster: *You push the knife into Father Torheim's throat, but instead of blood there's some kind of green, sulfur-smelling slime gushing from the wound.*

Player 2 (Astrid Lilja): *I drop the knife and back out of the privy.*

The Gamemaster: *The priest's body dissolves onto the floor in front of you. You hear the roar of a thousand burning fires, steel drums, and the clanking of chains being dragged across sand. The slime rises from the ground, slowly taking the shape of a creature. Two eyes emerge, then a mouth. It smirks at you. Make a Fear test. The Fear value is 2.*

Player 2: *I use Empathy. One success. I fail, but only suffer one Condition. I choose to flee.*

TERRIFIED

When Terrified, you must choose one of the below options:

- ♦ **Flee:** You must use all your actions to flee from the thing that frightens you. There is no time to pick things up, talk, or help someone else. You choose the nearest and fastest way out of there.
- ♦ **Freeze:** Your body refuses to move, rendering you completely immobile. You cannot talk or perform any actions whatsoever. If you are in a dark or concealed position, it takes a successful **VIGILANCE** test to spot you.
- ♦ **Faint:** Your body goes limp, and a veil of darkness descends over the world. If you are lying in a dark or concealed position, it takes a successful **VIGILANCE** test to spot you.
- ♦ **Frenzy:** You attack the nearest hostile person or creature with whatever weapon you are currently holding (or unarmed). You will not stop attacking until the enemy is vanquished. You cannot perform any fast actions except movement, and then only towards the enemy. If there are no enemies nearby, you explode in a fit of rage and start breaking things around you.

After your first turn while Terrified, you may try again to overcome your fear on each turn. Make the Fear test again (no action). If you fail, you remain Terrified another round, but you don't suffer any further mental Conditions. Even if you keep failing the Fear tests, you stop being Terrified when the scene ends.



RECOVERY

After violent or frightening encounters, you and your friends may need to heal your Conditions.

MEDICAL & MENTAL CARE

You can use **MEDICINE** to heal other people's physical Conditions, but not your own. You and your patients must spend a few hours on treatment, in a (reasonably) secure location.

Likewise, you can use **INSPIRATION** to cure others of their mental Conditions. In addition to spending a few hours in a safe place, your friends must willingly engage in close contact and dialogue with you.

If the skill test succeeds, your patients heal a total of three Conditions which you distribute between them. They decide which Conditions are healed. Broken can also be healed this way. Each extra success can be used to heal another three Conditions.

A patient cannot have their physical or mental Conditions treated by more than one person at a time. However, it is possible for one person to treat the physical Conditions while another treats the mental ones. While you are treating the Conditions of others, you yourself may not receive treatment.

RESTING

In addition to medical and mental care, you can heal your own Conditions by resting or engaging in an activity that provides relaxation. Summarize what happens or play a short scene. If alone, you heal one physical or mental Condition of your choice. If the scene involves another person, NPC or player character, or your memento (your memento can only be used once per session), you heal two Conditions.

Resting can only be done once per day, and the Broken Condition cannot be healed this way. If multiple characters are participating in the same scene, they can all heal Conditions from it.